

HOME INSURANCE — FULL POLICY TERMS & CONDITIONS

HomeShield Insurance Group | All Plan Tiers | Policy Year 2025

SECTION 1: DEFINITIONS

1.1 Key Definitions

BUILDINGS: The structure of your home including walls, roof, floors, ceilings, doors, windows, built-in fixtures and fittings, permanently installed kitchen units, bathroom suites, fixed glass, swimming pools, patios, paths, driveways, walls, gates, and fences — but only those within the boundary of the insured property.

CONTENTS: All household goods and personal belongings owned by you or members of your family that are normally kept in your home, including: furniture, carpets, curtains, clothing, electrical equipment, jewellery, watches, works of art, collections, bicycles, sports equipment, and money up to the stated limit. Contents do NOT include: motor vehicles (other than garden machinery), caravans, boats, aircraft, or trade goods.

EXCESS: The first part of any claim that you must pay yourself before HomeShield pays the remainder. The excess stated in your Policy Schedule applies separately to each individual claim event.

HOME EMERGENCY: An incident at the insured premises that is sudden, unexpected, and requires immediate action to prevent damage to the property or to make the property secure or habitable. Covered emergencies include: total failure of boiler or heating system; plumbing emergencies (burst pipe, major leak); roof damage making the property insecure; loss of main entry keys (locksmith call-out); electrical failure (partial or complete).

INSURED ADDRESS: The address shown on your Policy Schedule as the insured property.

PERIOD OF INSURANCE: The period shown on your Policy Schedule, normally 12 months.

SUBSIDENCE: The downward movement of the ground beneath the buildings, other than caused by: coastal or river erosion, the action of frost, or the normal compaction of newly made ground.

SUM INSURED: The maximum amount HomeShield will pay for a claim, as shown in your Policy Schedule. For buildings, this should represent the full rebuild cost (not market value) including site clearance and professional fees.

SECTION 2: BUILDINGS INSURANCE — COVERED EVENTS

2.1 What Is Covered

HomeShield will pay for loss or damage to the buildings at the insured address caused by any of the following events:

FIRE, SMOKE, EXPLOSION, AND LIGHTNING: Damage caused by fire (including wildfires spreading to the insured property), lightning strike, explosion, or smoke damage from a sudden malfunction of a fixed domestic appliance.

STORM AND FLOOD: Damage caused by storm (defined as windspeed exceeding Beaufort Scale Force 10 / 55 mph or exceptional rain, hail, or snow), or by flooding from rivers, lakes, or the sea. NOTE: Flood cover may be excluded or subject to higher excess in flood-risk zones (Flood Re certified properties are eligible for standard terms; non-Flood Re properties: check Policy Schedule for endorsements).

ESCAPE OF WATER: Damage caused by water leaking or escaping from: water tanks, pipes, or plumbing systems; washing machines, dishwashers, or other fixed appliances. **TRACE AND ACCESS:** HomeShield will also pay the cost of locating and gaining access to the source of the water leak, including the cost of making good after access, up to £5,000.

THEFT AND ATTEMPTED THEFT: Damage to the buildings caused by theft or attempted theft, provided there is evidence of forcible and violent entry or exit.

MALICIOUS DAMAGE AND VANDALISM: Damage caused intentionally by persons other than the policyholder or members of the household.

SUBSIDENCE, HEAVE, AND LANDSLIP: Damage caused by subsidence, ground heave, or landslip. Subject to £1,000 excess (all tiers). Excluded: damage caused by coastal or river erosion, normal settlement of newly built properties (within 10 years of construction), or damage to driveways, paths, or patios not connected to the main structure.

FALLING TREES AND BRANCHES: Damage caused by trees, branches, or lampposts falling onto the insured buildings.

VEHICLE AND AIRCRAFT IMPACT: Damage caused by vehicles, aircraft, or items falling from aircraft striking the insured buildings.

LEAKING HEATING OIL: Accidental leakage of oil from a domestic fixed heating installation, including cost of clean-up.

2.2 Buildings Exclusions

HomeShield will NOT pay for buildings damage caused by or consisting of: - Gradual deterioration, wear and tear, or lack of maintenance - Rot, mould, fungus, or woodworm infestation - Mechanical or electrical breakdown of any system within the building - Damage caused while the building is undergoing structural alteration, renovation, or extension - Damage to fences, gates, or hedges caused by storm or flood (structural walls covered) - The cost of repairing or maintaining the cause of damage (e.g., replacing the leaking pipe itself is not covered; only the resultant damage is) - Damage caused while the property is unoccupied for more than 60 consecutive days (Standard and Comprehensive) or 90 consecutive days (Landlord Plus) - War, invasion, terrorism, or nuclear contamination - Deliberate damage caused by the policyholder or a household member - Pollution or contamination (unless caused by a covered event such as oil leak from heating system)

SECTION 3: CONTENTS INSURANCE — COVERED EVENTS

3.1 What Is Covered

HomeShield will pay for loss or damage to contents at the insured address caused by: FIRE, SMOKE, EXPLOSION, LIGHTNING (same as buildings) STORM AND FLOOD (same as buildings) THEFT: Loss of contents caused by theft, provided there is evidence of forcible and violent entry or exit. Theft by a household member is not covered. Theft of valuables requires them to be listed as scheduled items if above the single article limit. WATER DAMAGE (escape of water from pipes, appliances) MALICIOUS DAMAGE AND VANDALISM ACCIDENTAL DAMAGE (Comprehensive Cover and above only; add-on for Standard) SUBSIDENCE (same as buildings) LOSS OF FROZEN FOOD due to a sudden breakdown of the freezer (up to £500) THEFT OR LOSS OF MONEY at home (up to £500)

NEW-FOR-OLD: HomeShield replaces damaged or stolen contents with a new equivalent item of the same specification, without applying depreciation, provided the item is less than 8 years old at the time of the claim. Items aged 8+ years are replaced at current market value.

3.2 High-Value Items and Scheduled Contents

Items individually worth more than the single article limit MUST be specifically listed (scheduled) on the policy to be covered for their full value. Unscheduled items are subject to the single article limit, regardless of their true value.

ITEMS REQUIRING SCHEDULING: Jewellery and watches (each item > single article limit); Works of art, antiques, and collectibles; Musical instruments; Photographic equipment; Sports equipment (e.g., golf clubs, skiing equipment); Electronic equipment (cameras, laptops – if above single article limit).

TO SCHEDULE AN ITEM: Contact HomeShield with a description, value, and supporting documentation (receipt, professional valuation dated within 3 years, certificate of authenticity). An additional premium will apply for scheduled items above the high-value items limit.

PROFESSIONAL VALUATION: For items valued above £5,000, a professional valuation by an approved valuer is required before the item can be fully scheduled. Valuations must be updated every 5 years or when market values change materially.

3.3 Contents Exclusions

HomeShield will NOT pay for: - Loss or damage caused by wear and tear, gradual deterioration, or scratching - Mechanical or electrical failure of any item (unless resulting from a covered event) - Loss of data, software, or information stored on electronic devices - Items in the open air, unless specified as covered (bicycles, garden furniture covered up to stated limits) - Motor vehicles (other than garden machinery up to £2,500) - Pets or livestock - Contact lenses or hearing aids (unless specified as scheduled items) - Business stock or trade samples - Items taken outside the home, unless 'away from home' cover is included in the policy

SECTION 4: PERILS & EXCLUSIONS IN DETAIL

4.1 Flood Cover and Flood Re Scheme

FLOOD RE: HomeShield participates in the UK government's Flood Re reinsurance scheme, which makes flood cover affordable for homes in high-risk flood zones. Properties built before 1 January 2009 in flood-risk postcode areas are eligible for Flood Re pricing. Properties built after 2009 are not eligible and flood cover may be excluded or subject to a higher excess.

FLOOD EXCESS: Standard and Comprehensive Cover: £250 excess for flood (same as standard). Flood Re properties in Band D+ flood risk: £500 excess. Non-Flood Re properties: £2,500 excess or flood exclusion (check Policy Schedule).

FLOOD DEFINITION: Flooding means the overflow of a body of water (river, lake, sea, or reservoir) onto land that is normally dry, or the accumulation of rainwater above ground level that results in damage. This does NOT include: - Water entering through an open window or door left open by the policyholder - Water damage caused by a leaking roof that does not qualify as storm damage - Groundwater rising through the floor (this is classified as subsidence / heave)

4.2 Subsidence in Detail

Subsidence is the most complex and expensive home insurance peril. HomeShield covers subsidence damage subject to the following conditions:

COVERED: Sudden downward movement of soil beneath the foundations causing structural damage to the building. Evidence of subsidence: diagonal cracks typically wider than 3mm, concentrated at corners of windows and doors, or progressive cracks that worsen over time.

NOT COVERED: Settlement — the initial bedding-in of a new building, which is normal for properties under 10 years old. Shrinkage of clay soil due to tree roots (covered if roots caused structural damage). Coastal or river bank erosion. Frost heave. Damage limited to paths, driveways, or garden walls not connected to the main structure.

SUBSIDENCE EXCESS: £1,000 per claim (all tiers). This excess applies each time a subsidence claim is made, even if related to a prior incident.

WHAT TO DO IF YOU SUSPECT SUBSIDENCE: Photograph all cracks with a ruler for scale; Note when you first noticed the cracking; Contact HomeShield to arrange a structural surveyor inspection (HomeShield will instruct a surveyor at our cost); Do NOT carry out remediation work without HomeShield's prior written approval.

SECTION 5: CLAIMS PROCEDURE

5.1 How to Make a Claim

STEP 1 — IMMEDIATE ACTION: For theft or criminal damage, report to the police immediately and obtain a crime reference number. For emergency damage (burst pipe, fire), take reasonable steps to prevent further damage (turn off water supply, call emergency services). Do NOT throw away damaged items before HomeShield has inspected them — this may invalidate your claim.

STEP 2 — NOTIFY HOMESHIFT: Contact HomeShield Claims on 0800 555 0800 (24/7) or at homeshieldinsurance.co.uk/claims as soon as possible after the incident — ideally within 24 hours for major damage, and within 30 days for all other claims.

STEP 3 — CLAIM REFERENCE: You will be given a claim reference number. Note this for all future correspondence.

STEP 4 — CLAIM FORM: Complete the HomeShield Claim Form (available online or sent by post). Attach supporting documentation.

STEP 5 — ASSESSMENT: HomeShield may appoint a loss adjuster or surveyor to inspect the damage. Please make the property available for inspection within 5 working days of the appointment.

STEP 6 — SETTLEMENT: HomeShield will make a decision within 15 working days of receiving all required documents for standard claims. Complex claims (subsidence, major flood, rebuild) may take longer.

STEP 7 — PAYMENT: Settlement is paid directly to your nominated bank account, or directly to an approved contractor if HomeShield manages the repair.

5.2 Documents Required for a Claim

STANDARD CLAIM (FIRE, STORM, ESCAPE OF WATER): - Completed claim form - Photographs of damage (minimum 4 photos per damaged area) - Receipts, invoices, or valuations for damaged/stolen items - Two independent repair quotes (for claims over £2,500)

THEFT CLAIM: - Police crime reference number (mandatory) - Completed claim form - Proof of ownership for stolen items (receipts, photos, bank statements, warranties) - Details of how entry was gained

SUBSIDENCE CLAIM: - Completed claim form with photos of all cracks (include ruler for scale) - Structural engineer's or building surveyor's report (if obtained independently) - History of any previous subsidence work on the property

SCHEDULED/HIGH-VALUE ITEMS CLAIM: - Original schedule listing from the policy - Professional valuation (must be within 5 years) - Proof of purchase or certificate of authenticity

SECTION 6: GENERAL CONDITIONS

6.1 Policyholder Obligations

You must: - Tell HomeShield about any change in risk (e.g., property becoming unoccupied for more than 60 days, change of use to a business, structural alterations, change in security measures) - Take reasonable precautions to prevent loss or damage and maintain the property in a good state of repair - Cooperate fully with HomeShield's claims investigation - Not admit liability, offer payment, or settle a claim against you without HomeShield's consent - Keep the property secured when unoccupied (five-lever mortice deadlock or BSI-approved equivalent on all external doors; key-operated window locks on all accessible windows)

SECURITY REQUIREMENTS: Minimum security standard for claims to be valid: External doors: five-lever mortice deadlock (BS3621) or multi-point locking system. Ground-floor and accessible windows: key-operated window locks.

6.2 Underinsurance

Buildings underinsurance: If your buildings sum insured is less than the true rebuilding cost, HomeShield may reduce any claim payout in proportion to the degree of underinsurance. EXAMPLE: If your home would cost £400,000 to rebuild but you have insured it for £300,000 (75% of true value), HomeShield may pay only 75% of any buildings claim. HomeShield recommends using the BCIS Rebuild Cost Calculator at bcis.co.uk to verify your buildings sum insured annually. Contents underinsurance: The same proportional reduction applies if total contents are insured for less than their true replacement value.

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